Jacen Salvador

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Education

San Diego State University **Graduated June 2026**
Bachelor of Applied Arts and Sciences in Computer Science *San Diego, CA*

Experience

mthdstudios **Jan. 2025 – Present**
Co-Founder & Software Engineer *San Diego, CA*

- Co-founded a two-person software studio that has shipped **2** consumer iOS apps to the App Store, working across product, engineering, and release.
- Ran the iOS release pipeline across both apps — **EAS** build and submission lanes, over-the-air update channels, and **Sentry** crash triage from TestFlight through production.
- Built and deployed the studio's marketing site on **Next.js** and **Cloudflare**, covering the homepage, product landing pages, and privacy/terms pages.

Client Web Development **Dec. 2023 – Jul. 2026**
Studio Avenue and PolarityVisions *Next.js, Sanity, tRPC, Drizzle ORM, MySQL*

- Built studioavenue.co for a post-production studio with Marc Jacobs, Golden State Warriors, and BLACKPINK credits, using **Sanity** as a headless CMS for non-technical publishing.
- Built **PolarityVisions**, a creative portfolio modeling many-to-many media and partner data in MySQL with **Drizzle ORM** behind a type-safe **tRPC** API.

Projects

Yearning - AI Conversation Simulator **Jun. 2026 – Present**
Published on the iOS App Store *Expo (React Native), Convex, DeepSeek, Cloudflare, RevenueCat*

- Engineered an LLM boundary layer bounding all client-controlled prompt input — message counts, character caps, allow-listed enums — before any billed model call.
- Designed **12** layered rate-limit buckets across per-user burst, per-tier daily quotas, and sharded global ceilings to cap cost abuse and protect availability.
- Integrated **DeepSeek** via the Vercel AI SDK with **Zod**-typed structured output, returning an in-character reply and coaching guidance in one validated call.

Larp - AI Photo & Video Editor **Jan. 2026 – May 2026**
Published on the iOS App Store *Expo (React Native), Next.js, Convex, fal.ai, Better-Auth, Turborepo*

- Architected a **Turborepo** monorepo over a three-tier catalog with **9** composite indexes, plus a nightly cron folding usage into scores that drive a trending feed.
- Orchestrated image and video generation on **fal.ai**, guarding every paid call with token-bucket rate limits, **RevenueCat** credits, and server-side entitlement checks.

Systems & Cloud Lab - UNIX System Administration **Jan. 2025 – May. 2025**
San Diego State University Lab Projects *Kubernetes, Docker, Azure Cloud, Proxmox VE, NGINX*

- Deployed multi-OS environments **(OpenBSD, Ubuntu, Solaris, AIX)** on Proxmox, configuring networking and DNS for inter-system communication.
- Engineered fault-tolerant containerized services with **Docker** and **Kubernetes** orchestrated on **Azure**, backed by **NFS** storage and self-managed GitLab repositories.

Technical skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, Java, C/C++
Frameworks: React, React Native (Expo), Next.js, Node.js, tRPC, TailwindCSS, Sanity
AI & Backend: Vercel AI SDK, DeepSeek, fal.ai, Convex, Drizzle ORM, Zod, MySQL
Infrastructure: Cloudflare Workers/R2, Docker, Kubernetes, Azure, Turborepo, CI/CD, Git